

ON **ANTARCTIC COASTS** THE **WINTER WINDS** CAN BLOW UP TO **200 MPH** (320 KPH)



EMPEROR PENGUINS ARE **UNDER THREAT** FROM **CLIMATE CHANGE**, AS RISING TEMPERATURES **MELT THE WINTER SEA ICE**

KEY

- Breeding site
- Swimming range



SOUTHERN
OCEAN

Sleek swimmer

The streamlined body of a penguin is superbly adapted for swimming. Underwater, these birds flap their paddle-like wings for propulsion.

Weddell Sea

Ronne Ice Shelf

Contact call

The call of an emperor penguin can be heard more than half a mile (1 km) away. Each bird recognizes the call of its mate, which helps them locate one another in the crowded colony.

A N T A R C T I C A

South Pole

Feeding time

Males feed their chick with a special curd produced from their food-pipe, until the mother arrives with fish and krill caught at sea.

Ross Ice Shelf

Ross Sea

Standing tall

Penguins stand very upright because their feet are set far back on the body. The emperor is the tallest of all—up to 4¼ ft (1.3 m).

Polar penguin

Emperor penguins feed in the icy waters of the Southern Ocean around Antarctica. They can dive deeper than any other seabird to catch fish and krill. Each year, emperors gather in their thousands at breeding sites around the coast to mate and raise their single chicks.

Breeding site

At colonies around the coast, emperors gather to find a mate. The female lays a single egg then returns to the sea, leaving the male to incubate the egg alone.